

DAILY MANNA

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Wednesday, July 1, 2026

GENUINE BURDEN

TEXT: ROMANS 10:1-4

— ♦ KEY VERSE ♦ —

"Brethren, my heart's desire and prayer to GOD for Israel is that they might be saved." (Romans 10:1).

— ♦ ... 🔑 ... ♦ —

Augustine of Hippo, one of Christianity's most influential theologians, lived a wild and dissolute life in his youth. He embraced Manichaeism, a dualistic religion, and lived a life far from God. His mother, Monica, was a devout Christian. For over seventeen years, she unceasingly prayed for his salvation. She followed him, wept over him, and sought out bishops and spiritual leaders to intercede. Wary of her persistence, one bishop finally told her, "Go, your son will be saved; the son of so many tears cannot perish." Monica's burden for her son was so profound that it drove her to relentless prayer and tears. She didn't give up, even when Augustine seemed furthest from God. Her burden for his salvation ultimately led to his dramatic conversion, a testament to the power of a heart burdened in prayer.

Before the 4th century, when the prayer and burden of Augustine's mother eventually led to his conversion, Paul the apostle had shown us what it means to demonstrate that heartfelt desire and burden for the salvation of our people. The fervour

was unmistakable, his zeal knew no bounds, and his passion was infectious. Israel's lack of understanding led them to establish their own standards of righteousness and remain in darkness. Israel was doubtlessly religious but ignorant of God's provision for salvation. Yet, Paul the apostle never gave up on them. Today, many still demonstrate zeal for God without true knowledge, which leads to a futile pursuit of righteousness.

As believers, our passion should align with Paul's—praying fervently and working tirelessly to save those still wallowing in self-righteousness. We must share the gospel with love, guiding seekers, including our relatives and fellow citizens, away from the path of destruction. We must lovingly point them to Christ, the Saviour of the world. Do not write them off. The provision of Christ on the cross at Calvary is also available for their redemption today. Supplicate, intercede, and go after them with genuine concern and love; the Lord will have mercy on them. The time to start is now.



THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Burden begets salvation breakthroughs



BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

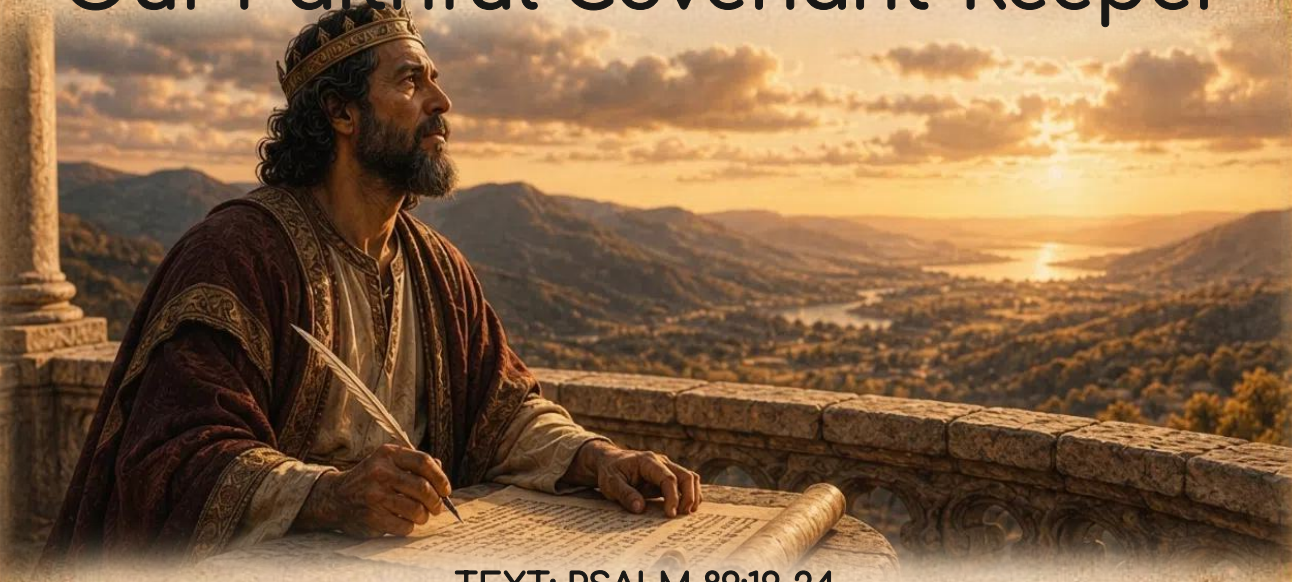
Genesis 1-3

DAILY MANNA

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Thursday, July 2, 2026

Our Faithful Covenant-Keeper



TEXT: PSALM 89:19-24

—❖— KEY VERSE —❖—

"The enemy shall not exact upon him; nor the son of wickedness afflict him. And I will beat down his foes before his face, and plague them that hate him" (Psalm 89:22,23).

—❖— ... ❖ —❖—

You might have heard the saying, "Promises are meant to be broken," especially in the business world. Sadly, this often proves true today, as people quickly make and break commitments at will. Even marriage, which is supposed to be the most sacred bond, isn't immune to this trend of infidelity. People might agree to terms on paper, but when it becomes inconvenient, they back out or end relationships at the first sign of trouble. God is different. When He makes a promise, He keeps it.

The passage under consideration brings us back to God's unwavering covenant with David. Ethan, the inspired writer of this psalm, reflects on the significant moment when the prophet Samuel anointed David to be the future king of Israel. This anointing was more than just a ritual; it represented God's choice and empowerment for leadership. The psalmist starts by recalling God's promise to David and his descendants, ensuring that David's dynasty would last forever. He describes the blessings that come with this promise: David would have divine support in ruling his kingdom; his people would be free from oppression, and his enemies—both external and within—would be swiftly defeated or struck down by plague. David would experience God's faithfulness

and mercy, which would benefit his subjects and clear the way for his kingdom's growth. His "horn," a symbol of his power, would be lifted high as God fights his battles, granting him victory and security.

As we reflect on this passage, we are reminded that God's promises are grounded in His faithfulness, not in our abilities or worthiness. David's anointing and the promise to his dynasty are a testament to God's sovereign choice and empowerment. In our own lives, we can find encouragement in God's faithfulness. Just as David's throne was secure because of God's promise, we too, will find safety when we build our lives on God, the ultimate covenant Keeper. There was a time when Israel strayed from God, and David's dynasty faced defeat in battle. Then, it seemed like God's promise to him would fail. Ultimately, the covenant was fulfilled through Jesus Christ, the Son of David, who will reign forever. Though men fail, God's faithfulness never fails!

Today, believers partake of God's promises through faith in Jesus. In case you are searching for a love that never fails, it can only be found in a relationship with the covenant-keeping God.



THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Faith in God's faithfulness is vital in our walk with Him



BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Genesis 4-6

DAILY MANNA

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Friday, July 3, 2026

Unravelling a Mystery



TEXT: Ephesians 3:1-7

❖ KEY VERSE ❖

"How that by revelation he made known unto me the mystery; (as I wrote afore in few words" (Ephesians 3:3).

❖ ... ❖

There are many diseases that doctors know very little or nothing about. They are mysteries. One of such mysterious diseases is "the mysterious epidemic that swept the world from 1917 to 1928. Half a million people were afflicted with a ghastly condition that could be part of the plot line of a horror film. The victims—very much alive and conscious—found themselves in inexplicably frozen states. This sickness first appeared in Europe and quickly spread around the world, reaching epidemic levels in North America, Europe, and India by 1919. About a third of those stricken with the illness, died. Of the survivors, nearly half eventually found themselves unable to interact physically with the world around them, all the while fully aware of their surroundings.

From today's text, Paul begins to speak of the great 'mystery' that was the central calling of his life. But it wasn't a 'mystery' in the sense that people typically think. This is not a 'mystery' that any human being can figure out and solve by good detective or guesswork. Rather, a 'mystery'—as the word is being used in the New Testament—is an aspect of God's redemptive plan for humanity that is known only to Him, revealed in due time by Him to humankind. This is something that is only known by God, but graciously, He allowed it to be revealed to Paul the apostle in due time. "That the Gentiles should be

fellow heirs, and of the same body, and partakers of his promise in Christ by the gospel." This became the nucleolus of Paul's ministry to the Gentiles.

Consequently, Paul the apostle needed to convince his Jewish brethren that it was God's will that the gospel message of salvation be taken to the Gentiles and indeed the world. But the Jewish religious hardliners, who were patently engrossed in the doctrine of Jewish exclusive right to salvation, would not understand. His fellow citizens became an albatross to his missionary work in the old Roman Empire and Asia Minor, where he undertook several missionary journeys.

When it comes to delivering a God-revealed mystery to sinful humanity, it can't be done in human power. Paul was, of course, unique—and he was uniquely suited by God's providence to minister this mystery in such a pioneering and authoritative way. However, he saw it as a mystery of which he became a minister according to the gift of the grace of God given to him by the effective working of His power (Ephesians 3:7). God has one mystery that we all should be aware of - that salvation is not only for an exclusive or predetermined set of people. We need to take the same message to everyone in the world because Christ died for the whole world.



THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

The reality of our salvation proves the veracity of divine revelation.



BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Genesis 7-10

DAILY MANNA

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Saturday, July 4, 2026

Lot of The Foolish



Text: Proverbs 12:14-20

❖ KEY VERSE ❖

"The way of a fool is right in his own eyes: but he that hearkeneth unto counsel is wise" (Proverbs 12:15).



A man who was hard-of-hearing was in the company of new acquaintances. One of the people entertained them with a funny story that sent everyone laughing. They observed that the man was not tickled by the story and suspected that he had a hearing impairment. When he realised what was happening, he belittled the story that caused the laughter, and told them he had a funnier story. They listened to him repeat the same story that had been told earlier. This confirmed the people's suspicion, and as they laughed at his blunder, he interjected, "Didn't I tell you I'd tell a funnier story that would cause you more laughter?"

The unwarranted pretence of the hard-of-hearing man is akin to the self-conceit of a fool. Today's text highlights some of the traits of a foolish person and their bitter consequences. Many things are associated with foolishness, but the worst is that the fool's way is right in his own eyes. By this, he prevents himself from ever getting wise. Foolery spares no aspect of the fool's life. He speaks indiscreetly, walks loftily, acts sinfully, and thinks deceitfully and vainly. He brings upon himself unimaginable misery here and hereafter.

Conversely, the wise treads cautiously and righteously and experiences true fulfilment, peace, and joy now and in eternity.

Someone is not a fool because of an occasional decision or choice. Sometimes, we make such mistakes. The Bible says, "The fool hath said in his heart, There is no God." A fool is, therefore, a person who disregards God; a practical atheist who acts as if there is no God. This disposition is at the root of all the deviant behaviours and wicked practices around us. The grim consequences of this indiscretion are too glaring to ignore – premature death, preventable diseases, unfulfilled careers, miserable living, and dishonour, to mention a few.

God invites you to savour His wisdom and the associated truth and righteousness, which result in satisfaction, peace, joy, and fulfilment. True wisdom is not gained from intellectual or academic exertion or exposure through travel and interactions. "The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom" (Proverbs 9:10). Rudimentary knowledge of God is not enough. The more you understand God's word, the wiser you become.



THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Recovery from foolishness starts when a fool realises his foolishness.



BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

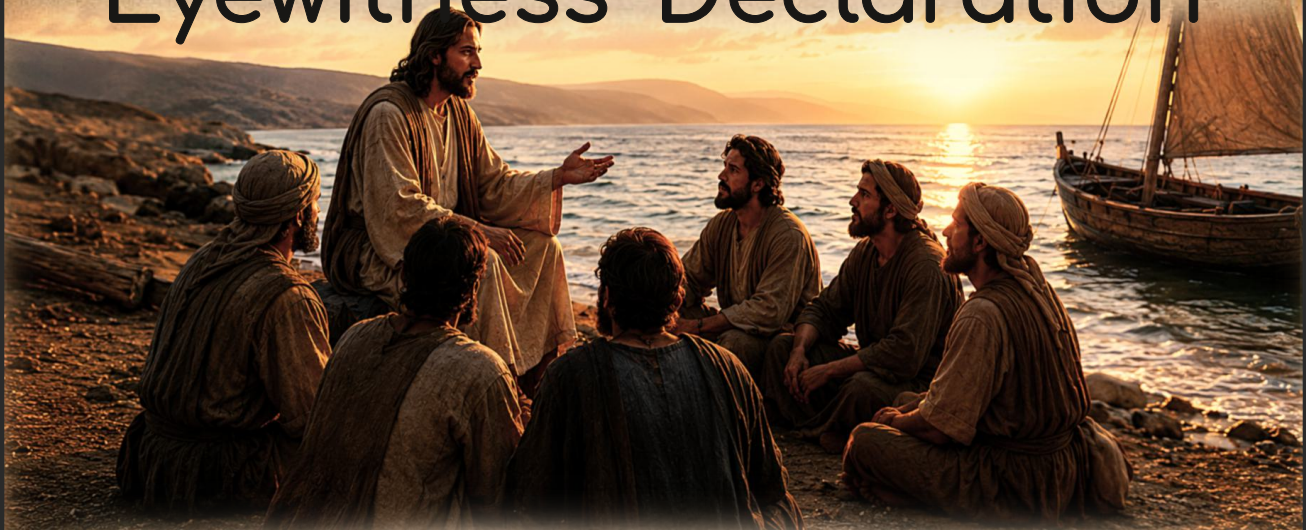
Genesis 11-13

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Sunday, July 5, 2026

Eyewitness' Declaration



Text: 1John 1:1-4

❖ KEY VERSE ❖

"That which was from the beginning, which we have heard, which we have seen with our eyes, which we have looked upon, and our hands have handled, of the Word of life" (1 John 1:1).



The accounts of eyewitnesses are usually reliable and often more factual than handed down tales or even recycled stories that carry exaggerated details.

The writer of this epistle, John the beloved, squares up and writes authoritatively in a manner akin to incorruptible judges who dispassionately weigh all the evidences of the two sides (plaintiff and defendant) and come up with incontestable verdicts that render all falsehood crashing and cascading like a pack of cards. Such verdicts are informed by the knowledge or intimacy with the facts surrounding the contestation. Based on first-hand and intimate relationship with Christ, John encapsulates his knowledge in four crisp verses. Here, he portrays a picturesque attestation of first, the dateless existence of Christ; second, the treasure of Christ's presence; third, the eternal and abundant life in Christ with its attendant resplendence; and finally, the humanity of Christ.

Knowledge anchors the Christian's faith in the Rock of ages. Chuck Swindoll, the American nonagenarian pastor and theologian sums up

the importance of knowledge exquisitely: "First, knowledge gives substance to faith. Second, knowledge stabilises us during times of testing. Third, knowledge enables us to handle the word of God accurately. Similarly, knowledge equips us to detect and confront error. Furthermore, knowledge makes us confident and consistent in our walk with God. Knowledge filters out our fears and superstitions."

The purposes set out in this epistle is noble. The first is to enhance and enrich the fellowship of saints. The second is to fill the hearts of believers with joy. Significantly, every believer must seek and make the best of the knowledge of the Person, power and presence of Christ. It is in His presence that we have fellowship one with another. Christian fellowship is two-dimensional. We must know the reality of fellowship with the Father and with His Son Jesus Christ before we can know the reality of fellowship with each other in our common relationship to God. The person who is not in fellowship with the Father and the Son is no Christian at all, and so, cannot share with Christians, the realities of their fellowship.



THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

The more we know the Lord, the better we can deal with men and moments.



BIBLE IN ONE YEAR
Genesis 14-16